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(Senior Furniture Designer & Buyer; 35+ years' experience)



BUYING
AGENTS
ASSOCIATION



Knowledge Session Report — Furniture Design Trends & U.S. Market Forecast (BAA)

Executive summary

The Buying Agents Association (BAA) hosted a knowledge session on **Furniture Design Trends & Market Forecast** to help members understand the current state and direction of the **U.S. furniture market**, and to outline practical steps for **Indian manufacturers/exporters** to compete more effectively.

Session details

- **Organizer:** Buying Agents Association (BAA)
- **Topic:** Furniture Design Trends & Market Forecast
- **Date:** 27 March 2026
- **Platform:** Zoom
- **Moderator:** Mr. Pramod Rana (Governing Body Member, BAA)
- **Speaker:** Ms. Allison Eremita (Senior Furniture Designer & Buyer; 35+ years' experience)

U.S. furniture market — key highlights

- **Market size (current):** USD 173 billion
- **Projected market size (2035):** USD 336 billion
- **Primary growth driver:** Home remodeling and reinvestment in existing homes (more than new housing).
- **Expected upturn:** Around **2027**, supported by stabilizing interest rates and Millennials entering peak homeownership years.
- **Key challenges:**
 - High mortgage rates
 - Rising material costs
 - Shifts in consumer spending habits

Major design trends (what buyers are looking for)

1. Modern Heritage

- Traditional craftsmanship with contemporary form language
- Emphasis on quality materials and visible joinery

2. Quiet Luxury

- Understated, refined aesthetics (not flashy)
- Neutral tones, premium materials, and elevated finishes

3. Japandi → evolving into Dark Japandi

- Japanese + Scandinavian influence: clean lines, natural textures, calm minimalism
- Shift toward darker, moodier tones for a sense of psychological comfort

4. Structured Maximalism

- Bold statement pieces and layered textures within an organized layout
- Growing traction in higher-end segments

What today's consumer wants (major demand signals)

- **Sustainability & compliance:** Increasing expectation for certifications (e.g., **FSC**) and ethical sourcing.
- **Quality over quantity:** Movement away from “fast furniture” toward durable, long-lasting products.
- **Tech integration:** Rising interest in smart/functional furniture (wireless charging, ergonomic design, modularity).
- **Transparency:** Buyers want clarity on how and where products are made.

Strategic opportunities for Indian manufacturers (recommended actions)

- **Develop unique finish stories:** Build differentiated finishes using local materials—avoid purely copying imported looks.
- **Use AI tools for design presentation:** Strengthen buyer pitches using visualization and presentation tools.
- **Scale production capacity:** Large buyers value reliability and consistent high-volume output.
- **Shift from reactive to proactive product building:** Create forward-looking product lines instead of producing only against orders.

Key takeaway

Competing globally is no longer only about price. Success in the U.S. market increasingly depends on **trust, transparency, sustainability, and design relevance**—and Indian manufacturers that invest in these capabilities are well-positioned to grow share in a market projected to reach **USD 336 billion by 2035**.

Session snapshot

The session was conducted live on Zoom on 27 March 2026, moderated by Mr. Pramod Rana, with participation from BAA members and the exporter community.



